

You won't bee-lieve the materials bugs and their relatives can produce. Thousands of years ago, people realized how useful bug-made products could be and started to farm bugs. Bug-made goods can still be found all over the world.



BEEES



Honey

Humans first collected honey from wild bees around 10,000 years ago. Now, bee farming and honey production are big business.



Beeswax

Honeybee workers make a special wax to build honeycomb. We use it in candles and varnish.



Royal jelly

Bees make royal jelly to feed their babies and their queen. We use it in face creams.

INSECTS



Food coloring

Some red food dyes are made of ground-up scale insects from South America.



Venom

Venom might sound deadly, but in medicine it can be helpful. Bee and ant venoms are used to treat swollen joints and damaged skin.

PROBLEMS

Think twice

Bugs make lots of useful materials, but the way we harvest and process these products, including silk and dye, can be cruel. Silkworm pupae will die when their cocoons are destroyed to make silk, and many scale insects must be killed for humans to make just a small amount of dye. It is important to think about this before buying products made from bug materials.

